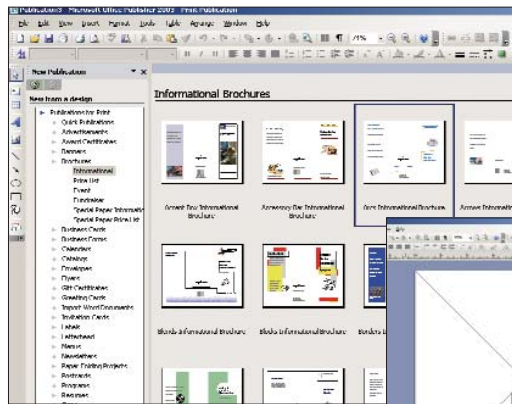


name suggests, it is at the end of the day a word processor, and can only do so much before it has you seeking different kind of professional help.

The middle ground, then, would be a package that can create a professional-looking publication swiftly and without added investment. Coming through in this hour of need is Microsoft Publisher 2003, which now comes bundled with your installation of Microsoft Office 2003. It offers a handy collection of tools to get your publication out as quickly and painlessly as possible.

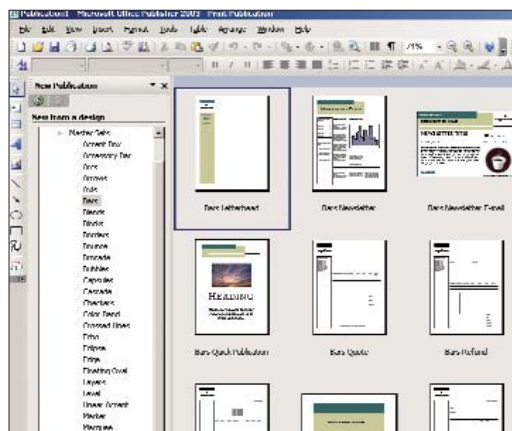


Publisher offers a huge collection of templates to suit your every mood

Pick Me! Pick Me!

The philosophy of Publisher is to minimise the time between your realising that you need a publication and actually having it in your hand. It offers templates for nearly all the print material you might ever need—letterheads, visiting cards, brochures, catalogues, flyers, advertisements, banners, greeting cards... whew!

For the restaurateur, there are templates for menus, take-out menus, and even wine lists. There are even a few whimsical templates, such as folding instructions for paper airplanes! Not content with print media, Publisher also offers templates for basic Web sites and e-mails. All you need to do is pick one and tweak it to your needs. And, if you aren't happy with the templates Publisher provides download more from Microsoft Office Online.



The Master Sets let you select a common theme for all your documents

With You All The Way

If you need a common theme to run through all your material, turn to Publisher's Design Sets. Depending on what you're looking for, design sets offer you sets of templates.

Consider the case of The Little PR Firm. One of their clients needs to organise an event to launch their new product. The Little PR Firm has to set up a Web site and send flyers and invitations for the event. If they're using Publisher, all they need to do is look up the "Special Event" design set—there are template sets for Web sites, brochures and invitations just waiting to be used. One step further is the star of this show—the Master Set that has templates for everything from calendars to purchase orders and invoices.

Beautifying Your Phonebook

If you use Excel or Access to organise your data, but are bored of plain old tables, Publisher offers some relief. One of Publisher's smartest features is its ability to integrate with data sources such as Access databases and Excel sheets. Use the Mail and Catalog Wizard to pick your data source, and apply a template to present the data. You'll soon see your customer database in your brand new "customer details" publication.

Look Here!

Another highlight of Publisher's template-driven approach is the Design Gallery. It offers



Use the design gallery (above) for some neat attention grabbers (left)



frequently-used items such as feedback forms, coupons and labels that you can insert into your publication. You can also add a healthy dose of zing using accents, pull-quotes (blurbs with interesting quotes), and our favourite, the Attention Grabber—"Unbeatable Prices!"

To The Presses!

After designing your publication, Publisher helps ensure that all is hunky-dory when you finally go to print. The first is the Design Checker that checks for data that's outside the page, hidden or overflowing text, even pictures that have been distorted upon resizing. Once Design Checker deems your publication safe for printing, use the Commercial Printing Tools to adjust